Be a Timothy

Last week we said not many of us are called to be a Paul. But we can all be a Timothy. → Why? After He had 3 qualifies before Paul recruited him. Remember?

1) Unfeigned faith
2) Mission clarity
3) Tender heart

(- one new one *)

This week we will look at some specific admonishments Paul had for Timothy.

*1) Paul approached Timothy as his own dearly beloved son

- Paul knows that his son will soak in his teachings. Timothy is a son Paul trusts to carry on his mission.

→ Isaac "Take responsibility" (Read Proverbs Daily)

2) Paul instructed Timothy to "stir up" the gift of God (II Tim 1:6)

stir up → get into the middle of it and make the fire alive again with intense repetition

It is natural for an unattended fire to go out. Let that sink in...

Here's something else: the biggest reason fires go unattended is fear

I have some big fires burning in my heart today

- 100 acres in Asafo
- 20 acres in Trede
- 50 acres in Afinso
- Orphanages all over Ghana
  - schools sports fields
  - churches farms/coffee
- Discipleship in our school preaching
  - campus pastor rotating through schools
  - bible clubs
- Road building equipment
- Brick factories
- Well drilling company
- Irrigation company

This gift was given to me nearly 20 years ago. Fear nearly killed it... the fire went untended/unstirred until I set my foot down on that tarmac in Accra. The Holy Spirit stirred it up and now it is on me to realize that if God gave me this dream HE WILL PROVIDE!!

The only thing that will kill the fire God placed in your heart is the fear to believe He can't deliver... So how do we victor in this? II Tim 1:7

Fear is not from Him. But you know what is FROM HIM?

strength - Power - dunamis - divine power
yes - Love - agape - divine love
no - Sound mind - discipline/self-control

So we said 1) Timothy was a son, he studied Paul and was wise; 2) Timothy was admonished to stir-up his gift. My men in Ghana, my sons, you have been revived recently - It is up to you now to keep that fire alive!

Number two for this week: II Tim 2:3
Endure hardness as a good soldier
Fancy way of saying: DON'T QUIT

How

Vs 4: DON'T GET ENTANGLED WITH THIS LIFE'S DISTRACTIONS. STAY LASER FOCUSED ON THE MISSION.

This will keep you out of the wilderness... this will keep you out of the UK or Russia when you should be building a work in Ghana...

1 - stir up
2 - Endure hardness

#3 II Tim 2:15 Study to shew thy self approved

Study - use speed/diligence, work endeavour, labour

Shew - stand beside/exhibit

Approved - acceptable

You won't be a Timothy without a message. You won't have a message if you don't spend time with the Author of the message
- Bill Waugh -

Staying on Mission - Back story

Timothy already:

1 Unfeigned faith
2) Mission clarity
3) Tender heart
4) Paul's beloved son in the faith

Timothy became:

Stirred up II Tim 1:6

He endured hardship II Tim 2:3

Studied to show... approved II Tim 2:15
This section is actually a roadmap or sys to completing your mission/part of His plan and avoiding the pitfalls that the enemy builds.

Study - use speed/diligence, work endeavor, labour

Show - stand beside/exhibit

Approved - acceptable
Rightly dividing the word of truth

Make a straight cut - don't get squirrely in your interpretation - I don't have much respect for a pastor that has to change Bible versions based on the point he is trying to make. God tells us that His word is not subject to any private interpretation. We don't get to soften what He strikes against or harden against His grace

Shun (don't partake, avoid)
profane (crosses the line) vain babblings (empty/fruitless)
why?
They aren't innocent.
They aren't cute
They aren't amusing/amusement
They will grow
They will multiply
They will change you.
They will devour you
Vs 21 says I should purge myself of these profane* and vain babblings†... these time wasters that transform into something that makes you worthless to the Kingdom * would you say it at the cost † does it make anything better?

II Tim 2:22 flee also youthful lusts *

* This is not symbolically or parbolically refering to a Joseph/Potiphar's wife scenario... this attacks the issue much earlier.

flee - literally = run away
implication: shun
analogy = vanish

→ same word Paul uses twice as good
lust - longing - where does longing take place? our minds and hearts. * The longing isn't the part to avoid... its the youthful part
What are we to do with our minds and hearts?
Renew our minds
Distrust our hearts

Watch this now:

Follow righteousness, faith, charity, peace, with them that call on the Lord out of a pure heart.

Follow - diōkō (dee-ō'-ko)
A prolonged (and causative) form of a primary verb dio (to flee) to pursue; by implication to persecute

What is Paul telling Timothy?

Check how you spend your time
Check with whom you spend your ti
Check the topics of conversation
Check what you are dwelling on

If you want to finish your mission, your time, your mouth, your relationships and your thoughts must all be in service to the mission:
Righteousness, faith, charity, peace with them that call on the Lord out of a pure heart is the acid test used to check those 4 things.

Who is this Timothy?

We will spend another week or so on Timothy but I wanted to take this time to look at who Timothy was and what he actually did.

Acts 16:1-5 is where Paul is introduced to Timothy's unfeigned faith that is mentioned in II Tim 1.

> Act 16:1-5 KJV 1 Then came he to Derbe and Lystra: and, behold, a certain disciple was there, named Timotheus, the son of a certain woman, which was a Jewess, and believed; but his father was a Greek: 2 Which was well reported of by the brethren that were at Lystra and Iconium. 3 Him would Paul have to go forth with him; and took and circumcised him because of the Jews which were in those quarters: for they knew all that his father was a Greek. 4 And as they went through the cities, they delivered them the decrees for to keep, that were ordained of the apostles and elders which were at Jerusalem. 5 And so were the churches established in the faith, and increased in number daily.

Our first glance shows us that he was a learner. How does that flesh out?

- Humble (Socrates said the only true wisdom is in knowing you know nothing. To which Plato attributed intellectual humility necessary for learning...
  Jesus said The disciple is not above his master: but everyone that is perfect shall be as his master. LK 6:40
  Humility in ministry (the power of humility)
  Humility in realizing that everything is supposed to be ministry

- Without a personal agenda
  - Richard vs Maxwell vs Otu and who is most valuable to me
  - It is why Tere Jr is so trusted in my ... everything. It is a trait that I genuinely hope he picked up from his old man.
    Rob Ferronte vs Daniel Hodges
    my new agenda for each of them

Dietrich Bonhoeffer said when Christ calls a man, He bids him, Come and die.
Jesus said take up your cross and follow me Mt 16:24 / MK 8:34 Mark 10:21 LK 9:23

- He was hungry for something that would come later
  My why for PTLC
  My why for Kairos

1) He was a learner / pupil / disciple
2) He had zero pedigree
   - I like this one... Paul was not a respecter of persons. He wanted Timothy is spite of the Jews
   Look at vs 1 again
   His mother was a certain Jewess believer BUT his daddy was a born.
   Look at vs 2: nobody of the brethren cared about that.
   Who cares about a pedigree?
   < 1% are those that want to partner with you because of the value of the pedigree to build something for themselves
   99% of the people who care about your pedigree only care for comparison's sake. (Look at verse 3)
   What do we know about Timothy?
1) He was a learner and everything that entails.
2) He had no background on which to boast

3) He had such a desire to do something BIG for God that he humiliated himself for the opportunity (vs 3)
Look what he did with Paul vs 4-5
I'm reminded of Samuel in Ghana and how he spent 2 weeks away from a wife and 2 babies that I didn't even know he had because He thought God might use him.
And God HAS

Who is Timothy Part 2

Last week we looked at Acts 16:1-5 the introduction to Timotheos. We learned he was a pupil/learner with humility and no personal agenda but hungry enough for something bigger to pay a price now; he was without a pedigree and the enemy knew it and used it while the brethren just loved and admired Timothy; and we know that he was so driven to serve his Savior that he subjected himself to humiliation.

Today we are going to skim over the parts of Paul's second missionary journey where Timothy is not mentioned from Acts 16:6 - 17:14 where he is again mentioned. So when (1) the entire band wanted to take the gospel into asia and God said no, when (2) they wanted to go into Bithynia and God said no, we will breeze past the multitude of implications in 16:6-8 alone ... (3) why did Paul want to go to Asia and Bithynia? (4) Why did the Holy Spirit forbid them? Skipping past the (5) Macedonian vison, (6) Lydias salvation and (7) Paul's imprisonment in Phillippi (where was Timothy? why wasn't he in jail?), (8) past the Phillippian jailor, (9) the earthquake, the (10) attempted cover-up of the bogus arrest. Blowing past the "rioting in Thessalonica and the Jews mobbing Jason and company into a Kangaroo court in order to try and capture Paul instead driving him to Berea (50 miles south) to where they chased him again trying to mob up the people against him. All the way past all that, Timothy is mentioned again in Acts 17:14 where something significant happens: The central figure of the narrative is suddenly gone, and Timothy has to adapt to this unplanned, unprecedented event.

God reveals something in these passages that inform Timothy's success and usefulness in the ministry; it is something that, if understood, would have resulted in 20+ families still serving God in Ghana. It is a truth that, if not applied, will describe why some of you Ghana for Christ men will not be useful in a year

It is a silent story told in the space between 17:15 and 18:5 while Luke's camera is on Paul and Timothy is off stage.

An immediate/jolting loss of leadership
Let me illustrate

March 95 - crushing
March 98 - guarded/defensive
March 99 - 4 men highlighted/crushing
Feb 6, 2001 - Act 17:14 crushing

"The Rev. Jack Hyles did the unthinkable Tuesday. The man who, for more than 40 years was a driving force spiritually and educationally to an uncountable tally of followers in Northwest Indiana and the country, died Tuesday morning

One of those 4 men that Dr Hyles highlighted as a potential replacement for him left the church after he wasn't elected as pastor, left the church he started when he the the church because his wife had an affair ...
One of these men was called to pastor FBC
Two of these men transferred the undying loyalty they had to the mission of Dr Hyles to the new pastor and still serve in key roles

What did Timothy do and what was the result?
- We know from Paul's letters to Timothy that military jargon and precision were part of Paul's work. So Timothy would follow the last known order.

Silas was the 2nd in command Timothy would have experienced the same dreamy ideas of being in charge that the man whose wife left him had ... but he didn't. (Acts 13:5-13:13 John Mark 12)
He followed Paul's instructions, returned to Thessalonica to strengthen & establish the church, reported back in 18:5 and look at the outcome in 18:5 Paul was PRESSED: constrained/arrested/to be taken with ... in other words he was crushed
1 Thess 3:1-2
If God calls you to a mission: Leadership may change; if the mission doesn't change, you don't change